

Lecture 5

Environments

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- Systems are described by their design.
 - Functional requirements provide the reason for the design's existence.
- Systems always exist in some given environment.
 - Non-functional requirements describe how the design should work with its environment.
- Systems and their environments are always interacting in some way.
 - The environment always initiates these interactions.
- A 'scenario' is a sequence of interactions between a system and its environment.
 - A global scenario is the integration of all scenarios together for some given system and environment pair.
- A 'business event' is something a system must perform when prompted by its environment.
 - Scenarios terminate when a system fulfills the business task it was prompted to perform by its environment.
- A 'business process' is the act systems engage in to fulfil business events.
 - One or more components of a system may be engaged in any given business process.
- A 'viewpoint' is a perspective that designs should take into account.
 - For example, a legal viewpoint, an economic viewpoint, etc.
 - Viewpoints are given for each business event.
 - * Inapplicable viewpoints should still be directly mentioned and specified as so.
- The modes of a system describe equivalence classes of similar system behaviours.